companies, at their behest, just to see how secure they were. They never were very secure and the work was boring. But it allowed me to continue with my own investigations and get back on my feet. I knew it wouldn't work out for me in the long run because I'm not sufficiently interested in money and not at all interested in legitimacy.

I am interested in what I can do to further the cause of justice. In 1993 part of that involved helping the police to break an Internet paedophile ring. I helped them to understand what these men were passing around on the Internet and how they were doing it. I could see how these people moved around on the Net in ways the police could not, because they didn't have the expertise. I could lead them to an understanding of who these people were. I wasn't coerced into this, and did it less to help the police, in fact, than because I was concerned about protecting children.

But the raid took something out of me, for a time. The old nomadic strain took hold and has never gone. I suppose to a large extent I was unhappy. More than unhappy: I was stressed beyond anything I'd ever known. That rebellious climate that had always surrounded me travelled inwards, and for a while I lived outdoors and felt anguished. If I want to be comical about it, and encourage my critics, I would say it was my period in the wilderness. The only bit of Jesus worth having is the bit where he percolates his rebellion, and he does that over forty days while eating berries, facing down the temptations of the Devil and preparing to do the do. Like Milton, I believe the Devil quite often has the best lines, so, for that reason, and more obvious ones, I won't be aligning myself with the God-child. Let's just say I was upset and felt abandoned as I wandered in the Dandenong Ranges National Park. I must have been exhausted as well, yet filled with a notion that significant achievements lay up ahead if only I could reach that point. In the Sherbrooke Forest the temperatures could be extreme: freezing at night, and in the day the mosquitoes ravaged me. I drank water from the creek and otherwise just picked up provisions from town. I wanted to be alone and contemplate my position. I never saw a computer. I was out of communication.

I felt I could be a good father to my son but not a good mother. I was good at teaching, structuring, protecting, even at the bedtime stories, but I was hopeless at the other bits, the more mundane and less heroic parts of parenting. Eventually, I came to be looking after my son. That brought me back into focus, and so, over time, did my old friend, communications. At